

Jiayang Li

Systems Game Designer · mobile free-to-play

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SUMMARY

Systems designer with five years on live mobile free-to-play games and 30+ shipped events, features and systems across two RPGs. My work covers companion systems, player creation tools, server-wide social events and competitive modes. I own features from concept to launch (rules, flows, UI prototypes, specs and acceptance review) and work daily with writers, artists, UI, engineers and QA.

EXPERIENCE

NetEase Games · Systems Designer

Beyond the World (世界之外), narrative otome mobile RPG · Apr 2024 – Mar 2026

- **Aurora Bedroom: real-time companion system.** Sole system designer, concept to launch. Built the space on two layers: an environment layer (24-hour live clock, day and night visuals and sound, random rain, light and window toggles) and a character-response layer (he keeps his own daily schedule, falls asleep on his own, wakes unpredictably, and reacts differently per character).
- **Whisper: paid layer of Aurora Bedroom.** Designed long-form audio scenes with no interaction prompts, made for listening before sleep and unlocked by main-story progress. Owned the unlock flow, payment-point placement, and the free first Whisper that lets players try the experience before buying more.
- **Wishes Across the Cosmos: Valentine 2026 creation event.** Lead event designer, concept to live. Players make a gift instead of receiving a written romance. Designed 12 collection levels with an AI-controlled companion who reacts in context, and a six-layer crafting system (silhouette, sand colors, ornaments, flowing oil, shimmer, seal) that offers reference bottles and palettes while keeping each result the player's own. Finished bottles get a poetic line instead of a score. Players shared them on social platforms on their own.
- **Teahouse Gossip: 6-day event, Nov 2024.** Lead event designer; owned the core loop, material system, clue system and narrative integration. Players run a teahouse and work out indirect guest orders across three independent dimensions, using a Tea Compendium. Built "no pressure" into the rules at three levels: no penalty for a wrong brew, no timers, no required input order. Structured 12 gossip threads across four leads as independent stories, so skipping a day costs nothing. Players asked for it to become permanent.
- **Mini-games and recurring events.** Designed a side-scrolling movement mini-game and recurring monthly and festival events.
- **Competitive analysis.** Produced a design teardown of *Love and Deepspace*, the closest genre rival.
- **Delivery.** Wrote specs with acceptance criteria, built UI prototypes in Photoshop, and ran acceptance review against spec before launch, working with writers, art, UI, engineering, QA and product.

BAIOO Family Interactive · Systems Designer

The Tale of Food (食物语), turn-based card RPG built in Unity · Jul 2021 – Apr 2024 · team of 70–80

- **Qimen Formation: a server-wide faction event (Oct 2022).** Lead event designer. Players are randomly assigned to one of two factions and share one live board with the whole server. Each player clears challenge levels in their own session to push a node's progress. The first faction to reach 100% claims the node, and five claimed nodes in a row win the round. Added a draw-and-reset rule for boards where no line is still possible.
- **Coordination without chat.** In the same event, each faction's top three daily contributors earn a cooldown-limited power to place markers the whole faction can see. That small signaling channel let tens of thousands of asynchronous players focus on one objective.

- **Gourmet Arena: 32-player draft tournament (Apr 2023).** Owned the competitive rules, pairing and roster rules. Every character is supplied by the system and drafted at the start (pick one of four, six times, then field four), so matches are decided by choices, not by spending.
- **Dual-character maze.** Designed a single-player puzzle mode where one player steers two characters at once; built the levels in configuration tables.
- **Story-performance authoring tool.** Wrote the requirements for the in-house tool used to stage story scenes; engineering built it.
- **Delivery.** Partnered with writing, concept art, UI/UX, engineering and QA from spec to launch.

SKILLS

- **Systems and feature design:** companion and character-response systems, creation and crafting systems, social and faction systems, competitive modes, event and mini-game design, unlock-flow and payment-point design, table-driven level design
- **Communicating design:** specs, UX flows, UI prototypes, acceptance criteria, acceptance review, competitive analysis
- **Tools:** Photoshop, Figma, Excel configuration tables, Jira- and Confluence-style trackers
- **Languages:** Mandarin (native), English (professional)

EDUCATION

- **Master of Information Technology**, University of Queensland, 2021. Coursework included interactive-technology design studio, human-computer interaction and software engineering.
- **Bachelor of Arts (Economics)**, University of Queensland, 2019